

Beginner's Country Guitar

**taught by
Fred Sokolow**



BASIC STRUM, WITH ALTERNATING BASS

Chord diagrams for A and E chords are shown above the staff.

A Chord Diagram: Treble clef, key of D major (F# C# G#). Fingering: 1 (D4), 2 (F#4), 3 (A4).

E Chord Diagram: Treble clef, key of D major (F# C# G#). Fingering: 1 (E4), 2 (F#4), 3 (G#4).

The musical notation shows a 4/4 time signature with a repeating strum pattern. The bass line is indicated by numbers 0, 2, 1, 2 on the bottom staff.

JAMBALAYA

Chord diagrams for A and E chords are shown above the staff.

A Chord Diagram: Treble clef, key of D major (F# C# G#). Fingering: 1 (D4), 2 (F#4), 3 (A4).

E Chord Diagram: Treble clef, key of D major (F# C# G#). Fingering: 1 (E4), 2 (F#4), 3 (G#4).

The musical notation shows a 4/4 time signature with a repeating strum pattern. The bass line is indicated by numbers 0, 2, 1, 2 on the bottom staff.

Lyrics: Thibo - deaux, style, Fon - tai - neaux, go hog wild, the place is and be buz - zin' gay - o. Kin - folk Son of a

Chord diagram for A chord is shown above the staff.

A Chord Diagram: Treble clef, key of D major (F# C# G#). Fingering: 1 (D4), 2 (F#4), 3 (A4).

The musical notation shows a 4/4 time signature with a repeating strum pattern. The bass line is indicated by numbers 0, 2, 1, 2 on the bottom staff.

Lyrics: come to see Y - vonne by the do - zen. Sing, Dress in gun, we'll have big fun on the bay - ou. jam - ba - etc.

JAMBALAYA — ADDITIONAL VERSES

Goodbye Joe, me gotta go, me oh my oh.
Me gotta go pole the pirogue down the bayou.
My Yvonne the sweetest one, me oh my oh.
Son of a gun, we'll have big fun on the bayou.

Chorus:

Jambalaya and a crawfish pie and filé gumbo.
'Cause tonight I'm gonna see my shaz amio.
Pick guitar, fill fruit jar and be gay-o.
Son of a gun, we'll have big fun on the bayou.

Settle down far from town, get me a pirogue,
And I'll catch all the fish in the bayou.
Swap my mon to buy Yvonne what she need-o.
Son of a gun, we'll have big fun on the bayou.

BASIC WALTZ STRUM, WITH ALTERNATING BASS

A **E**

BASS RUNS

A **E**

To E... To A...

A MAJOR SCALE

A (start)

WALTZ ACROSS TEXAS

E A

TURNAROUND

My

A E

wor - ries a - cross trou - les as have with just you off in and my gone, arms, the

A

mo - ment a - that cross you came in with view. you. And Like with

A E

your sto - ry - in book mine end - ing I could dance lost on and your on, charms. } I could

WALTZ ACROSS TEXAS — ADDITIONAL VERSE

6

BASS RUNS

D

To G...

G

etc.

A

To D...

D

etc.

D MAJOR SCALE

D (start)

WILD SIDE OF LIFE

D G

A D

Oh, the

D

glam - our wait of the be gay night life has lured you to the for

wait to be an - y - bod - y's sweet - heart, and for -

A D

pla - ces where the wine and li - quor flow, where you

get the man who al - ways loved you so. I never... etc.

D A⁷ D

ENDING TURNAROUND

WILD SIDE OF LIFE — ADDITIONAL VERSES

You wouldn't read my letter if I wrote you,
 You never answer if I call you on the phone.
 But there's something that I'm longing to tell you,
 So I wrote it in the words of a song.

Chorus:

I never knew God made honky tonk angels.
 I should have known that you'd never make a wife.
 You gave up the only man who ever loved you,
 And went back to the wild side of life.

BASS RUNS

D A⁷

To A⁷... To D...

WILL THE CIRCLE BE UNBROKEN

D

0 2 0 2 2 2 2 2 0 2 2 2 0 2 2 2 0 2 2 2 0 2 2 2 4 2 0 2 2 2 4 2 4 2 2 2 4 2

G

D

0 3 3 0 0 0 0 2 0 3 0 0 2 0 2 2 2 2 2 2 2 2 2 2 2 2 0 2 2 2 0 2

0 2 0 2

A⁷

D

4 2 2 0 2 0 2 2 2 0 2

Well, I

fol - lowed close be un - hind her, tried to
cir - cle cle be un - bro - ken, bye and

Guitar fret numbers: 0, 0, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 0, 2

hold up and be brave. But I
bye, Lord, bye and bye. There's a

Chords: G, D

Guitar fret numbers: 3, 3, 0, 0, 3, 3, 0, 0, 3, 3, 0, 0, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 0, 0

could not keep from cry - ing when they
bet - ter home a - wait - ing in the

Guitar fret numbers: 0, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 0, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 0, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 0

laid her in the grave. Will the
sky, Lord, in in the sky. sky.

Chords: A⁷, D

First ending: 1. Will the
Second ending: 2.

Guitar fret numbers: 0, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 3, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 0, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 0, 2, 2, 2, 2, 2, 0

WILL THE CIRCLE BE UNBROKEN

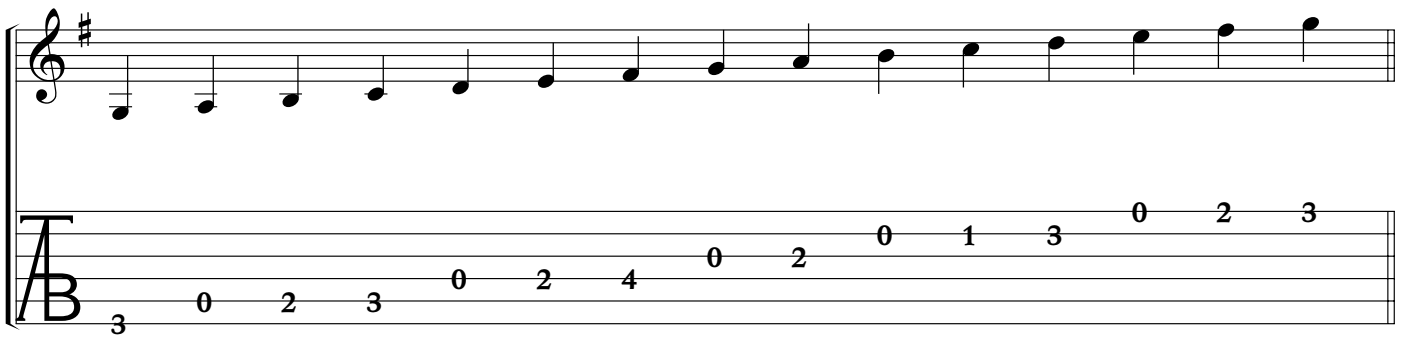
ADDITIONAL VERSES

I was standing by my window on a cold and cloudy day,
When I saw that hearse come rolling, for to carry my mother away.

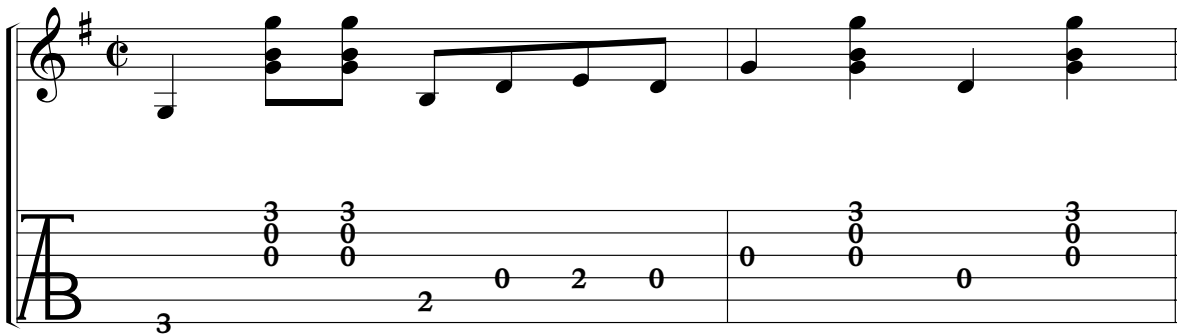
Well I told that undertaker, "Undertaker, please go slow,
'Cause that body that you're hauling, Lord, I hate to see her go."

Went back home then, my home was lonely since my mother she had gone.
All my brothers, sisters crying, what a home so sad and alone.

G MAJOR SCALE



G RUN



THE BOTTLE LET ME DOWN

D G

INTRO

G

Each night I leave the bar - room when it's
night I leave the bot - tle let me

o - ver, not and feel - ing an - y pain at clos - ing
down, and let your mem' - ry come a -

D

time. But to-night your mem' - ry left me much too
round. The one true friend I thought I'd

so - ber, found, I could - n't drink e - nough to keep you off my mind. To - night the bot - tle let me

mind. To - down. To -

night the bot - tle let me down.

THE BOTTLE LET ME DOWN ADDITIONAL VERSE

I've always had a bottle I could turn to,
and lately I've been turning every day.
But the wine don't take effect the way it used to.
I'm hurtin' in a most familiar way.

BASS RUN

E A

To A...

The 'BASS RUN' exercise is in E major (three sharps) and 3/4 time. It consists of three measures. The first measure has a treble staff with a half note E and a quarter note chord of G#-B-D# (E major triad). The second measure has a treble staff with a half note A and a quarter note chord of C#-E-G# (E major triad). The third measure has a treble staff with a half note A and a quarter note chord of G#-B-D# (E major triad). The bass staff shows fingerings: Measure 1: 0, 1, 1, 1, 1; Measure 2: 0, 2, 4; Measure 3: 0.

E MAJOR SCALE

The E Major Scale is shown in treble and bass staves. The treble staff shows the scale from E4 to E5. The bass staff shows the scale from E2 to E3. The fingerings are: Treble: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10; Bass: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10.

I'M SO LONESOME I COULD CRY

INTRO

Chords: E, B⁷, E

Did you
The

ev - - er see a rob - in weep when the
si - - lence of a a fall - ing star lights

leaves be - gin to die? That
up a pur - ple sky. And

Chord: E⁷

means he's lost the will to live. I'm so
as I won - der where you are, } I'm so

Chords: A, E

B⁷ To Coda Φ E

lone - some I could cry.

E

SOLO

E⁷

A E D.C. al Coda

CODA E

cry.

I'M SO LONESOME I COULD CRY ADDITIONAL VERSES

Hear that lonesome whippoorwill, he sounds too blue to fly.
That midnight train is whining low, I'm so lonesome I could cry.

I've never seen a night so long when time goes crawling by.
The moon just went behind the clouds to hide its face and cry.

I'M MOVIN' ON

E

1

§

tried to tell you from time to time, but you just wouldn't listen, wouldn't

big eight wheeler rollin' down the track means your true lovin' daddy ain't

E⁷ A⁷

pay me no mind, I'm movin' on, on, roll on, roll in

comin' back and I'm movin' on, on, I'm movin' on, on, roll on, roll in

E B⁷ To Coda ☺

on, on. You've broken your vow and it's

on, on. You've broken your vow and it's

The musical score is for a piece in 6/4 time with a key signature of three sharps (F#, C#, G#). The melody is written on a treble clef staff, and the bass line is on a bass clef staff. The lyrics are: "all over now, I'm mov - in' on." The score includes a guitar accompaniment with fret numbers (0, 1, 2) and a bass line with fret numbers (0, 1, 2). The piece is marked with a tempo of 120 and a key signature of three sharps.

E *D.C. al Coda*

That

CODA B⁷ E

sayin' so long, I'm mov - in' on.

I'M MOVIN' ON — ADDITIONAL VERSES

Mister fireman, won't you listen to me
 'Cause I got a pretty mama in Tennessee.
 Keep movin' on, keep rollin' on.
 So shovel the coal, let this rattler roll and keep movin' me on.

That big loud whistle as it blew and blew, said:
 "Hello to the southland, we're comin' to you,
 and we're movin' on. Oh, hear my song."
 You had the laugh on me, so I'm settin' you free, and I'm movin' on.

Mister engineer, take that throttle in hand,
 This rattler's the fastest in the southern land.
 Keep movin' me on, keep rollin' on.
 You're gonna ease my mind, put me there on time, and keep rollin' on.

You switched your engine, no I ain't got time
 For a triflin' woman on my main line,
 'Cause I'm movin' on. You've done your daddy wrong.
 I've warned you twice, now you can saddle the price 'cause I'm movin' on.

But someday, baby, when you've had your play,
 You're gonna want your daddy but your daddy will say:
 "Keep movin' on. You stayed away too long.
 I'm through with you, too bad you're blue, keep movin' on."

BASS RUNS

C **G⁷**

To G⁷...

etc.

C **F**

To F...

etc.

C MAJOR SCALE

C (start)

BLUE EYES CRYING IN THE RAIN

G⁷ C

Now One In my bright a hair has turned to sil - ver. star shines down from heav-en, part-ing,

G⁷ To Coda 1. C

All blue blue my eyes eyes life I've loved in vain.

2. C C⁷

cry - ing in the rain.

F

Some - - - day when we meet up yon - der,

C

G⁷*D.C. al Coda*

we'll stroll hand in hand a - gain,

CODA

G⁷

C

cry - in' in the rain.

SOLO

cry - in' in the rain.

1. G⁷ C

2. G⁷ C F C

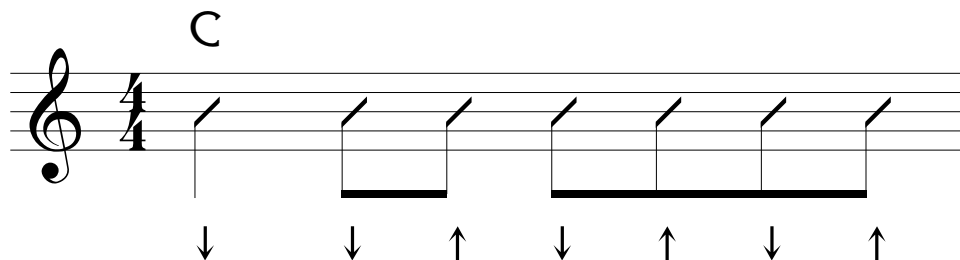
Blue eyes cry - in' in the rain.

BLUE EYES CRYING IN THE RAIN

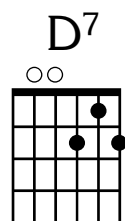
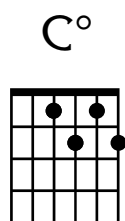
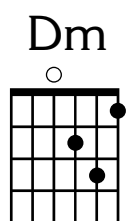
ADDITIONAL VERSE

In the twilight glow I see blue eyes crying in the rain.
 When we kissed goodbye and parted, I knew we'd never meet again.
 Love is like a dying ember; only memories remain.
 Through the ages I'll remember blue eyes crying in the rain.

COUNTRY-ROCK STRUM



NEW CHORDS FOR “SILVER WINGS”



SILVER WINGS

C

Silver wings way shining in the sun lone - light, ly.

Dm

roar - ing en - gines headed somewhere in Sil - ver wings,

G⁷

flight. They're taking you a - slowly drifting out of

C To Coda ☺ F G⁷

sight. "Don't leave me," I cried, "Don't

C C° C D7

take that air - plane ride." But you locked me out of your

G7 D.C. al Coda

mind, left me stand - ing here be - hind. Silver

CODA C

Slowly drifting out of sight.

CHORD FAMILIES

Key	I Chord	IV Chord	V Chord
C	C	F	G or G7
G	G	C	D or D7
D	D	G	A or A7
A	A	D	E or E7
E	E	A	B7

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